

UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA, SAN DIEGO

MGT 459: Venture Innovation, Growth Strategy, and Simulation

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COURSE OBJECTIVES

Our class focuses on the topic of Contextual Growth and Entrepreneurship, which makes students reflect on their current context and tailor their growth and entrepreneurship path, thereby accelerating their career trajectory. The course exposes students to a variety of options on the risk/reward spectrum, including Acquisition Entrepreneurship, Side-hustles, Scalable Entrepreneurship, Corporate Entrepreneurship, and Angel/Venture Investing. Students develop a Personal Entrepreneurial Plan (PEP) and/or a business pitch deck, as well as engage in a multi-week simulation. The simulation, originally developed at Stanford University, helps us experience the dynamics of a venture lifecycle and challenges us to raise money and strategically invest in growth while building wealth for the founders and stakeholders.

Through a combination of real-life venture case studies and a venture simulation, we learn and immerse ourselves on the topics of venture innovation, business model development, venture financing, and growth strategy. In addition, we will learn first-hand from distinguished alumni/entrepreneurs and venture capitalists in the life-sciences and technology industries their journey of juggling a new venture and developing/executing a business model while working full-time and learning the economics of the industry to build a thriving new venture. The examples include companies that went from an Idea to an IPO to others that are still well into their journey towards major milestones. Our goal is to develop the creative, strategic and critical thinking skills characteristic of an innovative, opportunity-driven, and entrepreneurial manager. We consider different types of startup/enterprises in the life sciences and information technology industries as well as lifestyle/service businesses. We also consider other approaches such as buying your way into entrepreneurship. The course may help students get a firmer grasp of the nuances and trade-offs, find their innovation sweetspot, and develop their professional growth plan in an established or start-up setting. We challenge students to build on their personal leadership plan to chart out their entrepreneurial/growth trajectory for the medium time horizon.



PERFORMANCE EVALUATION

The final grade in this class will be based on your performance as follows.

Class Engagement (Online Contribution/Participation)	20%	(Individual)
Case Analysis Quiz	20%	
Professional Growth Sweetspot Reflection	20 %	(Individual)
Exam	20%	(Individual on final session)
Simulation Debrief or Pitch Presentation	20%	(Team penultimate class)
Total	100%	

Class Engagement/Participation (20%):

Your class participation (contribution to class discussions) will count for 20% of the class grade.

You are expected to be an active participant throughout the entire class and to contribute to the quality of the discussion. Please note that the frequency (i.e., the quantity) of your interventions in class is not a key criterion for effective class contribution.

Some criteria used to evaluate class contribution are as follows:

1. Is the participant deeply engaged in class?
2. Is the participant a good listener? Are the points made relevant to the discussion? Are they linked to the comments of others? Do the comments show evidence of analysis of the case?
3. Is there willingness to test new ideas, or are all comments "safe"? (For example, repetition of case facts without analysis and conclusions).
4. Do comments clarify or build upon the important aspects of earlier comments and lead to a clearer understanding of the case?

Note: You are expected to attend EVERY class; you are responsible for the material covered in class whether or not you attend. However, I realize that despite your best efforts you might have been forced to miss a class due to unforeseen emergencies. If you must miss a class, you may provide a one-page written evaluation of the material or case to be covered (contact us for details of specific assignments). This assignment should be e-mailed in advance of class for planned absences and by the BEGINNING of the following class for emergencies.

Case Analysis Quiz (20%):

Few minutes of class sessions will be allocated to an in-class Canvas quiz based on a case assigned for that class. These are to be taken without any external/AI guidance and would be mostly administered using a lockdown browser. There will be four quizzes based on case studies.

Professional Growth Sweetspot Reflection: 20%

One of the objectives of this class is to figure out how venture creation and analysis fits in your career journey. As a first step, you will be asked to create a first draft of your Growth trajectory and sweetspots. Then you will work in pairs to offer feedback to a classmate and update your own Statement based on the feedback received. You will receive credit for your first draft feedback provided to your partner on their first draft, and an updated second draft submitted to the Canvas dropbox.



Venture Simulation Debrief: 20%

We will partake a Venture simulation and you will work with a classmate to complete the simulation. As a team, you present your simulation results and lessons learned.

Exam: 20% Offers the opportunity to practice and synthesize the material.

COURSE MATERIALS

The class is mainly an action-oriented class with reference articles, books, and videos assigned through Canvas. A small collection of cases are available through a digital course reader and a few others that can be downloaded from the class Canvas site. (link for the reader will be provided by MBA Programs.)

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY

As members of the Rady School, we pledge ourselves to uphold the highest ethical standards. The UCSD Policy on Integrity of Scholarship can be viewed [here](#).

STUDENTS WITH DISABILITIES

A student who has a disability or special need and requires an accommodation in order to have equal access to the classroom must register with the Office for Students with Disabilities (OSD). The OSD will determine what accommodations may be made and provide the necessary documentation to present to the faculty member. The student must present the OSD letter of certification and OSD accommodation recommendation to the appropriate faculty member in order to initiate the request for accommodation in classes, examinations, or other academic program activities. **No accommodations can be implemented retroactively.**

Please visit the [OSD website](#) for further information or contact the Office for Students with Disabilities at (858) 534-4382 or fosorio@ucsd.edu.

COURSE SCHEDULE

A detailed course outline is provided on Canvas, and **I expect that you will read the assigned materials in advance, and prepare for a thoughtful class discussion based on questions provided in Canvas.** You and I will work together to create the best learning environment that we can. I will schedule extra office hours and review sessions as the need arises. In the spirit of continuous improvement, I will seek informal feedback several times during the quarter. Please let me know if there is anything I can do to make this class better for you!



Session 0	Getting started on Canvas
Session 1	Intro to Class: Venture Strategy and Entrepreneurship Options
Session 2	Acquisition Entrepreneurship; ; Side-Hustles/Side-Startups (Vertu A due-individual assignment in-class quiz)
Session 3	No Class - MLK Day (Acquisition Entrepreneurship and Search Funds - online)
Session 4	Conceiving, Growing and Scaling Ventures: Start of VC Simulation (Vertu B due- individual assignment in-class quiz)
Session 5	Growing Pains: Addressing the Chicken/Egg Dilemma in Entrepreneurship (FMKT case in-class quiz)
Session 6	Business Model Design and Evolution (Zipcar case in-class quiz)
Session 7	NO CLASS Presidents Day (Business Model Design and Evolution Online)
Session 8	Intrapreneurship and Spinouts; Venture Fund Formation (Orchid case)
Session 9	Startup Game/venture Pitch Presentations
Session 10	In-class Exam / Final Debrief with Professor

Case Studies:

Hotel Vertu: Analyzing the Opportunity in the Boutique Hotel Industry ("Vertu A")

Hotel Vertu: Financing the Venture in the Boutique Hotel Industry ("Vertu B")

FreeMarkets Online

Zipcar: Refining the Business Model

Orchid, Inc.

Educational Articles:

Buying Your Way into Entrepreneurship (see course packet)

Identifying and Exploiting the Right Entrepreneurial Opportunity...For You

Research and Other Canvas Articles:

[Personality Traits of Entrepreneurs: A Review of Recent Literature](#) (loaded on Canvas)

Startup Game Introduction (See Canvas site)

